

How fast do rockets go?

Rockets travel incredibly fast to reach space. If they didn't, the Earth's gravity would pull them back down again. The powerful Ariane 5 rocket has reached 23,287 mph (37,476 kph)—nearly 6.5 miles (10.5 km) per second!

Launching satellites.

Ariane 5's job is to carry satellites into space. Satellites orbit (go around) the Earth, and help to make our internet, television, and cell phones work.

Feeding fuel.

A large tank stores the rocket's fuel and feeds it to the engine below.

A rocket can travel at least 30 times faster than a passenger jet.

Power boost.

Extra engines called "solid rocket boosters" give the rocket more power. Once they have done their job, they are released from the rocket and fall into the sea.

